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## Bunyoro, an African kingdom

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A word should be said about the relationship between grandparents and grandchildren. In accordance with the classificatory usage which I have described, a grandfather's siblings are called "grandfather," regardless of sex, and a grandmother's siblings are called "grandmother," regardless of sex. Indeed all the members of both parents' mothers' lineages (who are all "mothers"—either male or female—to each of the parents) are called "grandmothers." Thus the odd fact that Nyoro may have male "grandmothers" and female "grandfathers" makes sense when the essentially "group" reference of Nyoro kinship terms is understood. Further, the assertion that Nyoro can marry their grandmothers seems less bizarre when we realize that what is meant is that it is permissible for a man to marry into his father's mother's clan.

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The relations between grandparents and grandchildren are friendly and intimate, contrasting strongly with those between fathers and sons. A boy may joke and play with his grandfather in a way which would not be permissible with his father, and Nyoro grandparents, like their Western counterparts, are often said to "spoil" their grandchildren. We spoke earlier of the incipient hostility between fathers and sons; grandfathers have already been replaced by their sons, and so are, as it were, out of the battle. Nyoro sometimes say that grandfathers are "like brothers," thus stressing the equality and friendliness of the relationship.

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## Marriage and Affinity

Nyoro think of marriage as a more or less permanent union between a man and a woman, the offspring of whom have recognized status as their children. Ideally marriage should involve the payment of brideweath (formerly in cattle, now in cash) and the establishment of enduring relations between the husband and his wife's people. Even where no bridewealth is paid, the children still belong to the father's clan and lineage, but the husband's status, especially in regard to his in-laws, is then much lower. Bridewealth nowadays averages about ten pounds, which is quite a lot of money in a community where most peasants' cash incomes during a year hardly exceed this amount. Most marriages are monogamous, but Nyoro still like to have two or more wives if  56 they can afford it, and even Christians sometimes have another wife besides their "church" or "ring" wife. A Nyoro may not marry into his own, his mother's, or his mother's mother's clan; he may marry into his father's mother's clan, provided that the relationship is not too close. Nyoro approve of marriage with neighbors; they say that it is a good thing to know something about one's prospective wife and her family before one becomes engaged. Most marriages are still between families who live within a day's walk of each other; this means that most people have affines within easy reach and see them often.

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